summarise this Spoke about what's been happening the last month.
Spoke about dad and sharing my therpay info with them -
While we have evolved to protect ourselves, we don't put up barries for no reason.
There is some reason in your past that you have put up this barrier.
and it's ok to have that barrier there.

then spoke about mum and dad and their divorce when I was 8
having to grow up and fill an adult role as a child -
psych said children only fill that role if it is available. Which means my parents werent there for me.

She asked me when my parents divorced - when I was 8
she said there's never a good time, but that's about the worst time for it to happen.
Because when you turn 8 that's when you start to disconnect from your parents and find your place in the world
you start questioning and answering "who is chris?"
and when you're entire world is flipped upside down. you don't get to answer that question "who is chris"
And you put up these barriers to protect yourself

She said mum probably did her best, but she wasn't able to fill the role that you needed.

She said I have a lot of lived trauma from when I was young, and it's why you are the way you are.
you weren't able to process a lot of the things you had as a child.
and so you didnt' get to develop in a standard way. That's a lot to take on for a non developed brain.

we spoke about finnance anxiety and why i didn't buy the house in brisbane
and how that relates to my logical brain and emotional brain. I Logically had the money and could make repayments, knew the property was good.
but emoptionally couldn't stomach the finance anxiety

I've had a lot of negative life experience
and that's why I look to the negative a lot
My experience has been, there's danger everywhere

Things not working out and that I don't have good track record for things working out, that's why my
emotional brain doesn't allow me to think things are going to work out.

Here’s a clear summary of your session:

Over the past month, you discussed what’s been happening in your life, particularly around your parents and your hesitancy to share therapy information with your dad. Your therapist explained that we don’t create emotional barriers for no reason — they form to protect us. There’s a valid reason from your past that led you to put this barrier up, and it’s okay that it exists.

You talked about your parents’ divorce when you were 8 and how you had to step into an adult role as a child. Your therapist noted that children only take on adult roles if that space is available — which suggests your parents weren’t fully able to be there for you emotionally.

She explained that while there’s never a “good” time for divorce, age 8 is particularly difficult. Around that age, children begin forming their identity and asking, “Who am I?” When your world was turned upside down at that stage, you didn’t get the stability needed to explore and answer that question. Instead, you developed protective barriers.

She acknowledged that your mum likely did her best, but wasn't able to meet the emotional needs you had at the time.

Your therapist reflected that you carry significant lived trauma from childhood. You weren't able to properly process what was happening, and that impacted your development. That's a heavy load for a young brain to carry.

You also discussed financial anxiety and your decision not to buy the house in Brisbane. Logically, you knew you could afford it and that it was a good opportunity. But emotionally, the anxiety felt overwhelming. This highlighted the tension between your logical brain and emotional brain — even when things make sense on paper, your emotional system is wired to anticipate danger.

You recognised that you've had many negative life experiences, which has shaped a worldview where danger feels constant. Because things haven't consistently worked out in the past, your emotional brain struggles to believe they will work out in the future.

Assume you are a trained psychotherapist. talk to me about the points here and draw out the connecting dots, be brief

I'm going to reflect this back to you in a way that connects the threads.

At 8 years old, your world fractured at the exact stage you were meant to be forming identity. Instead of asking "Who am I?", you were implicitly asking "How do I survive this?" That shift is profound. Identity development paused; protection took priority.

When a child steps into an adult role, it usually means the emotional space was unheld. You learned early that stability comes from you — not from others. That creates competence, but it also creates hyper-vigilance. Your nervous system learned: *things fall apart, and I have to manage it*.

The barrier with your dad makes sense in that context. If vulnerability wasn't safe or reliably received, your system protects it. Barriers aren't immaturity — they're adaptive

intelligence.

Now fast forward to the Brisbane house decision. Logically, you had capacity. Emotionally, your system associates commitment + instability with danger. Buying a house isn't just a financial choice — it's exposure, risk, permanence. Your emotional brain doesn't evaluate spreadsheets; it scans for threat based on lived memory. And your lived memory says: "When things feel stable, they can collapse."

Your financial anxiety isn't about money. It's about safety.

Your tendency to expect negative outcomes isn't pessimism — it's pattern recognition based on early experience. If your formative years taught you that security is fragile and support is unreliable, your brain will bias toward worst-case scenarios to prevent being blindsided again.

So the connecting dots look like this:

Early rupture → premature adulthood → protection over identity → hyper-responsibility → threat sensitivity → difficulty trusting stability → emotional override of logic.

None of this means you're broken. It means your nervous system did exactly what it needed to do at 8.

The work now isn't removing the barriers. It's helping your system learn that you're no longer 8 — and you don't have to survive in the same way anymore.

Can you change the formatting I don't want to read an essay

Sure. I'll keep it simple and direct.

- At 8, when your parents divorced, you were at the stage of forming identity.
- Instead of "Who am I?", your brain shifted to "How do I cope?"
- Protection became more important than self-development.
- You stepped into an adult role.

- That usually means the emotional space wasn't being held for you.
- So you learned: *I have to manage things myself.*
- That creates competence — but also hyper-vigilance.
- Your system expects instability.
- It scans for danger automatically.
- The barrier with your dad makes sense.
- If vulnerability didn't feel safe then, your system protects it now.
- Barriers = adaptation, not weakness.
- The Brisbane house decision fits the same pattern.
- Logically: safe.
- Emotionally: risk = potential collapse.
- Your nervous system doesn't trust stability.
- Your "things won't work out" belief isn't negativity.
- It's your brain trying to prevent being blindsided again.

Core thread:
Early instability → early responsibility → protective wiring → difficulty trusting safety → emotional brain overriding logic.

Nothing here is random. It's consistent.

She said I had insecurity, I've seen things not work out a LOT. And so I've never seen things where they do work out.

does this also tie into my relationship that failed? We were very much in love, but we broke up because I was too afraid to get married.

Yes. It ties in very cleanly.

If your core experience has been:

- things fall apart

- security is fragile
- good things don’t last

Then love + permanence (marriage) doesn’t just mean happiness.
It also means **maximum exposure to loss**.

Marriage isn’t just commitment.
To your nervous system, it can feel like:

- “What if this collapses?”
- “What if I choose wrong?”
- “What if I lose everything?”
- “What if I get blindsided again?”

If you’ve repeatedly seen things not work out, your brain builds a protective rule:

> Don’t go all in. It’s safer to step back than to be abandoned or destabilised.

So when the relationship moved toward permanence, your emotional system likely interpreted that as high risk — even if consciously you felt love.

This isn’t about not loving her enough.
It’s about your system not trusting stability enough.

The same pattern shows up:

Early instability → expectation of collapse → fear of permanence → pull back before it can fall apart.

And here’s the painful part:
If you leave first, you stay in control.
If it falls apart on its own, you relive being 8.

That’s usually what’s underneath fear of marriage in someone with your history.

My psych said I am alsways looking back, drawing from experience, or I am always looking forward.

never really looking at the right here and now.
that's why I never get anything done, I don't do the things to improve my life, I don't live in the moment.

That observation fits the same pattern.

If you grew up needing to anticipate instability, your brain learned two survival strategies:

- **Look back** → scan past experience for patterns ("When did this go wrong before?")
- **Look forward** → predict risk and prepare ("How could this fall apart?")

Both are forms of control.

But the present moment is where uncertainty lives.
And uncertainty, for your nervous system, equals danger.

So instead of being in the now, your mind time-travels:

- Past = evidence gathering
- Future = threat management

The problem is: action only happens in the present.

If you're:

- analysing past failures
- forecasting future collapse

there's no psychological space left for calm, grounded movement today.

Not getting things done isn't laziness.
It's a nervous system stuck in protection mode.

When you live in survival mode, the goal isn't growth.
It's prevention.

So the deeper pattern becomes:

Early instability → chronic threat scanning → past/future focus → difficulty tolerating uncertainty → avoidance or paralysis → life feels stalled → reinforces belief that things don't work out.

You're not failing at life.
You're overusing a strategy that once kept you safe.

The real shift isn't "be more productive."
It's teaching your system that the present moment is not dangerous.

can you connect the dots here and see what's wrong with me. I'm 31.

I'm going to be careful with your wording.

There's nothing "wrong" with you.
There is something **consistent** about you.

Here are the dots, cleanly connected:

- At 8, your world destabilised.
- You had to grow up early.
- You learned security is fragile.
- You learned you must anticipate problems.
- You learned it's safer to be self-reliant than vulnerable.

From that, your system developed three core adaptations:

1. **Threat orientation**
   You expect collapse because you experienced it early.
2. **Control through thinking**
   You live in past (evidence) and future (prediction) to avoid being blindsided.
3. **Avoidance of full commitment**
   Houses. Marriage. Big irreversible moves.
   Not because you don't care — but because permanence feels like high-risk exposure.

Now at 31, the problem isn't trauma happening.
The problem is your nervous system still behaving like it might.

You are operating with an 8-year-old threat map in an adult life that requires risk, uncertainty, and trust.

That creates:

- Paralysis
- Overthinking
- Fear of things working out
- Pulling back from stability
- Not living in the present

It can feel like something is defective.

But what I see is this:
You built a highly intelligent protection system.
It just hasn't been updated.

The question isn't "What's wrong with me?"
It's "Why is my system still preparing for collapse?"

And the answer makes sense.

Let me ask you something gently:
When things start going well in your life, what do you feel in your body?

Describe some of my major flaws.
Describe how I can use some of these things to my advantage.

describe some practical exercises or experience I can do to overcome these problems

I'm going to answer this directly — but not harshly.

Likely Major Flaws (as patterns, not character defects)

1. **Catastrophic bias**
   You overweight negative outcomes. Your brain treats possibility as probability.
2. **Avoidant decision-making**
   When stakes feel high (marriage, property, big life moves), you hesitate or withdraw to reduce exposure.
3. **Over-intellectualising**
   You try to think your way to emotional safety. Logic becomes a shield.
4. **Hyper-responsibility**
   You feel you must anticipate everything. That leads to pressure and paralysis.
5. **Present-moment avoidance**
   You live in analysis (past) or projection (future), which prevents decisive action now.
6. **Difficulty tolerating uncertainty**
   You want guarantees before committing — but adult life doesn't offer them.

None of these are moral failings. They're outdated survival strategies.

How These Are Actually Strengths

1. **Risk awareness → Strategic thinking**
   You likely see blind spots others miss. In business or investing, that's powerful.
2. **Caution → Long-term planning**
   You don't jump impulsively. That protects you financially and socially.
3. **Emotional depth → Capacity for loyalty**
   The fact you feared marriage suggests commitment matters deeply to you.
4. **Pattern recognition → High intelligence**
   You connect dots quickly. That's cognitive strength, not weakness.

The goal isn't removing these traits.
It's reducing their dominance.

Practical Exercises to Rewire This

1. Micro-Risk Training (Build Tolerance for Uncertainty)

Daily: do one small thing that has uncertain outcome but low stakes.

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- Make the call.
- Publish the idea.
- Book the thing.

Your nervous system learns through experience, not insight.

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2. “What If It Works?” Rebalance Drill

When you catch:

> “This might fall apart.”

Force equal airtime:

> “What if this works out extremely well?”

Not positive thinking. Just probability balancing.

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3. 5-Minute Present Lock

Set a timer for 5 minutes.
During that time:

- No planning.
- No analysing.
- No reflecting.
- Only the task in front of you.

Train your attention like a muscle.

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4. Exposure to Commitment (Gradual)

You likely avoid irreversible-feeling decisions.

Practice committing to:

- A 3-month fitness plan.
- A 6-month lease.
- A pre-paid course.

- A booked holiday.

Teach your system: commitment ≠ collapse.

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5. Body Check When Things Go Well

When something positive happens:
Pause.
Notice if anxiety rises.
Stay with it for 30 seconds.

This is critical.
Your system may interpret “good” as “vulnerable.”

The Real Core Work

You don’t need to become fearless.
You need to increase your tolerance for uncertainty.

At 31, your problem isn’t trauma.
It’s that your threat detection is calibrated too high.

That is adjustable.

Let me ask you something direct:

When you imagine fully committing — to a person, a city, a career path — what feels more uncomfortable:

- The possibility it fails
  or
- The responsibility of choosing and not being able to blame circumstance later?